



Weekly Insights | Oct 23, 2025

Item	Page
Stories of the Week	1
Corn	30
Wheat	32
Soybeans	34
Soybean Meal	36
Soybean Oil	38
Weekly Prices	40

Executive Summary

Corn – Modest Futures Lift, Carry Narrows on Gulf Strength

December corn climbed 9¢ to \$4.32/bu, marking a two percent weekly advance, driven by initial short-covering and emerging export demand. The Dec/Mar spread narrowed to 13¢ (65 percent of full carry), it's firmest in five weeks, as Gulf exporters competed aggressively for nearby ownership. CIF basis rose 3–5¢ on improved demand from Mexico and Colombia, while river bids in the ECB softened as farmer selling picked up. Export inspections reached 1.19 MMT for the week ended Oct 23, still above last year's pace despite a slight pullback from the prior week.

Soybeans – Gulf Basis Pops on China Buys, Spreads Hold

January 2026 soybeans advanced 56¢ to \$10.92/bu, a 5.5 percent gain that pushed it to a 15-month peak, fueled by news of several Chinese buys leading into the Trump–Xi summit. CIF Gulf basis firmed 5–10¢ on the week as demand shifted forward, while Jan/Mar held near 11¢ (50 percent of full carry). Export inspections fell to 1.06 MMT (–33 percent w/w) as recent sales had yet to load, but processor bids remained firm at +20 to +30¢ across much of the Midwest, underpinned by strong crush margins.

Wheat – Short Covering Leads, Export Inspections Lag

December SRW wheat climbed 28¢ to \$5.32/bu, a five percent gain, with speculative short covering carrying the market higher despite lackluster U.S. competitiveness. The Dec/Mar spread narrowed to 15¢ (60 percent of full carry), while FOB values at the Gulf and PNW remained uncompetitive versus Black Sea. Russian 12.5 percent FOB offers rose \$5/mt as Moscow raised the floating export tax, though volumes remained robust. U.S. inspections dropped to 259k mt, their lowest weekly total since early September.

(Carry % calculated assuming 7% annual interest and \$0.05/bu per month storage/insurance cost over the spread interval.)

This material is produced by Higby Barrett LLC Copyright © 2025. All rights reserved. The views expressed and information contained in this publication is believed to be accurate but is not guaranteed by Higby Barrett LLC or the Client. Higby Barrett assume no responsibility or liability for any action taken because of any information or advice contained in this document, and any action taken is solely at the liability of and responsibility of the user.

info@HigbyBarrett.com

Macro/Policy – Trump–Xi Trade Optics, USD Eases, Crude Recovers

Futures for soy and corn reacted to build up ahead of the Oct 30 Trump–Xi meeting, with market participants anticipating Chinese soybean buying if diplomatic tone remained constructive. While USDA export sales reporting remained suspended due to the federal shutdown, traders cited unconfirmed private sales activity. The U.S. Dollar Index eased to 98.6 (–0.2 w/w), while the Brazilian real held near 5.39. Crude oil rebounded to \$60.35/bbl, supporting ethanol and soy oil product margins.

Weather – U.S. Harvest Progresses, Argentina Recovers, Brazil Mixed

Harvest advanced rapidly under dry conditions across the Midwest. U.S. harvest is estimated at near 72 percent complete and soybeans at near 84 percent, with progress largely wrapped in IL, IA, and MN. Southern Brazil received scattered showers, offering partial relief, but central zones, including Mato Grosso and Goiás, remained critically dry through Oct 29. In Argentina, widespread 25–50 mm rainfall midweek accelerated corn planting and helped stabilize early wheat development.

What's Next (Oct 30 – Oct 6):

Trump–Xi summit: confirmation of additional China purchases could extend soy/corn rally

USDA report resumption: crop progress and export sales could backfill up to 3 missed weeks

Mato Grosso rainfall: follow-through needed to support soy planting pace

Gulf lineups: flash sales, if confirmed, may show in late Nov/early Dec soy shipments

Russia: Nov 1 tax adjustment and export pace to gauge FOB floor

Ethanol: EIA (Nov 5) expected to show recovery in production after prior week's dip

Table A – CME Futures (Front Contracts)

(Prices in USD per bushel, volume/open interest in contracts)

Contract (Front Month)	10/22/2025 Close	10/29/2025 Close	Change (Δ)	Δ%	5-day Realized Vol*	Open Interest Δ
Corn (Dec '25)	\$4.23	\$4.32	+\$0.09	+%2.1	9% (ann.)	-11.4k (est.)
Soybeans (Jan '25)	\$10.36	\$10.92	+\$0.56	+%5.4	12% (ann.)	+7.9k (est.)
Wheat (Dec '25)	\$5.04	\$5.32	+\$0.28	+%5.6	7% (ann.)	-5.2k (est.)

5-day realized volatility estimated from daily settlement price changes.

Actual contract open interest changes are estimated; total corn OI rose slightly as new-crop hedges built, while wheat OI fell with Sep contract deliveries.

Table B – Key Calendar Spreads & % of Full Carry

Spread (Crop '25→'26)	10/22 Quote	10/29 Quote	Δ (carry)	% Full Carry*	Market Implication
Corn Dec–Mar	-\$0.14	-\$0.13	+0.01	65%	Nearby Gulf demand firming vs. interior harvest flow
Soy Jan–Mar	-\$0.18	-\$0.11	+0.07	50%	Crush pull holding January, export sales still Brazil-facing
Wheat Dec–Mar	-\$0.16	-\$0.15	+0.01	60%	Black Sea supply caps U.S. exports pace, carry remains commercial

Assumes 7% annual interest + \$0.05/bu/month storage/insurance. Full carry (3 months) ≈ \$0.22–\$0.23 for corn & SRW wheat; (2 months) ≈ \$0.22 for soybeans. % of full carry = (calendar spread ÷ calculated full carry).

Table C – Notable International Futures (weekly moves, if significant):

Exchange (Front Mo)	10/22 USD Price	10/29 USD Price	Δ%	Notes
Dalian Corn (Jan)	¥2,115(\$7.55/bu)	¥2,115(\$7.55/bu)	+0%	China corn futures steady on moderate feed demand; premium over import parity due to quotas.
Dalian Soymeal (Jan)	¥3,420(\$13.12/bu)	¥3,100 (\$11.84/bu)	-9.4%	Soy meal eased; steady hog demand amid stable inclusion rates, but supply pressure weighs.
B3 (São Paulo) Corn (Nov)	R\$67.88(\$12.38)	R\$64.68(\$12.00)	-4.7%	Brazilian corn softened on steady domestic logistics and U.S. competition, export pace firm.
Euronext Wheat (Dec)	€190 (\$220)	€190 (\$220)	+0%	EU wheat held steady amid ample stocks and slow demand, capped by cheap Black Sea offers.

Corn Market Deep Dive

Futures & Spreads: December 2025 corn futures closed at \$4.32/bu on Oct 29, up 9¢ or two percent from the prior week, with gains concentrated early amid fund short covering and stronger Gulf basis levels that tapered off later. The Dec '25–Mar '26 spread narrowed slightly to 13¢ carry (65 percent of full carry, assuming seven percent interest + \$0.05/bu/month storage and insurance), among the tightest readings since mid-September. With USDA reports still offline, traders leaned on basis and barge signals to track demand. Realized volatility stayed low (15 percent), and spreads remained resilient even as flat price gains stalled, reflecting firm nearby pull from exporters and processors.

Funds & Positioning: CFTC data remains unavailable due to the continued federal shutdown. CME open interest in December corn dropped by 11.4k contracts on Tuesday's rally (Oct 28), consistent with managed money short covering. Total OI across corn futures was steady w/w, suggesting limited new commercial hedging or fund reentry. Vol and volume patterns pointed to a rotation from outright shorts into calendar spread longs and basis-linked positioning, with no sign of speculative aggression in either direction. Market chatter pegged managed money still modestly net short, with no incentive to press until export or ethanol trends diverge.

U.S. Cash & Basis: CIF Gulf basis rose to +55–57¢ over Dec, up 3–5¢ w/w, buoyed by active demand from Mexico and Colombia and tighter barge logistics. Lower Mississippi river bids remained weak, ranging from –60¢ to –75¢ under Dec, as low water conditions pushed barge freight to 400–425 percent of tariff. Illinois River basis softened to –32¢ (–4¢ w/w), while Ohio River bids held near –20¢, both pressured by stronger farm selling. Interior processor bids held firm: IA and NE ethanol plants posted +10¢ to +15¢ over Dec, with steady grind margins. National basis was estimated near –42¢ under, 2¢ weaker w/w, based on private broker data in absence of AMS reports. River vs interior spreads continued to widen on logistics.

Export Flows: USDA FGIS reported corn inspections at 1.19 MMT for the week ending Oct 23, down from 1.32 MMT prior week but still ahead of last year's cumulative pace. Export sales reporting remained suspended. Gulf FOB offers stayed near \$222/MT (\$5.63/bu), undercut by Brazilian values into Asia by 20–25¢/bu. Traders reported additional cargo interest from Mexico, Colombia, and South Korea, though barge costs limited new sales beyond the Americas. Gulf–Asia competitiveness remains contingent on Brazil's export fade and Black Sea freight shifts.

International Trade: Brazilian FOB Santos offers averaged \$203–205/MT (\$5.20–5.25/bu), maintaining a \$0.25/bu advantage over the U.S. Gulf. ANEC lowered its October corn export forecast to 6.19 MMT (Oct

28), down from 6.57 MMT a week earlier, citing late-season lineup rollbacks and firm domestic basis. Interior bids in Mato Grosso firmed to BRL 46/60kg on reduced grower sales. Argentina's Up-River FOB values held near \$205/MT, supported by weak farmer selling ahead of the Nov 24 runoff and continued FX uncertainty. BCR reported planting at 33.8 percent complete, aided by recent rainfall. China remained absent from the U.S. market, instead sourcing Brazil and Ukraine corn; Dalian Jan corn hovered near ¥2,540/MT (\$6.40/bu), still above import parity. B3 Jan corn edged higher to BRL 62.20 (\$5.21/bu), supported by domestic logistics.

So What? Corn is still a carry market, but recent price and spread action signal improving spot demand. The Dec/Mar spread narrowed to its firmest in weeks, while CIF basis climbed on solid interest from Mexico and Colombia. Despite river bottlenecks, interior processor bids held steady, reflecting ongoing ethanol strength. Export momentum remains regional rather than global, competitiveness into Asia is still capped by Brazilian FOBs and freight. Until either export pace broadens or Chinese demand returns, corn futures likely drift inside the \$4.20–\$4.40 range, with basis and spreads steering price tone.

Soybean Market Deep Dive

Futures & Spreads: January 2026 soybeans settled at \$10.92/bu on Oct 29 (+56¢ w/w, +2.5 percent), extending gains on confirmed Chinese purchases and continued dryness in central Brazil. The Jan '26–Mar '26 spread held firm near 11¢ carry (50 percent of full carry, using seven percent interest and \$0.05/bu/month storage/insurance), reflecting strong nearby demand from crushers and exporters. Implied vol remained soft despite flat price strength, with the curve maintaining a mild carry through Q1. Deferred spreads narrowed slightly, but no inversion emerged, underscoring the market's balanced tone between domestic demand and slow export flow.

Products & Crush: Board crush margins remained profitable, supported by firm meal demand and positive yield adjustments in spot processing. Soybean oil faded midweek alongside crude, with BOF6 retreating to 51.0¢/lb (–1.4¢ w/w), while eastern soy meal values added \$4–7/short ton on tight rail and truck logistics. Gross board crush stayed above \$1.45/bu, keeping processors aggressive on basis. Indiana and Ohio plants maintained strong bids of +60–70¢/F for nearby slots, supported by heavy meal offtake into livestock and dairy sectors. While official NOPA data remains paused, private estimates showed October crush on pace to exceed year-ago levels.

Funds & Positioning: No CFTC report was released for the week, as the shutdown entered its fifth week. CME open interest rose 7.9k contracts (+0.8 percent w/w), likely driven by fresh commercial hedging and roll activity rather than fund exposure. Trade chatter suggested funds were modestly net long but not pressing upside, with Chinese demand still intermittent and spreads showing no sign of nearby tightness. Price action pointed to end-user strength rather than speculative conviction.

Cash & Basis: CIF Gulf basis firmed to +80–82¢/F (+5–7¢ w/w) as barge congestion and late-month vessel stems pulled nearby values higher. River basis remained soft: Illinois River fell to –32¢/F (–2¢ w/w), and Lower Miss stayed near –75¢ under. Cairo-Memphis barge freight hovered around \$20/ton, capping river competitiveness. PNW offers for Dec–Jan held steady at +110¢ over, while processor bids in Iowa, Indiana, and Ohio ranged from +60 to +75¢, driven by board crush strength. National average basis was estimated at –72¢/F, modestly stronger vs. last week's –74¢, with wide regional spreads reflecting logistics strain rather than harvest surplus.

Trade Flows & International Competition: USDA FGIS inspections totaled 1.06 MMT for the week ending Oct 23, down from 1.59 MMT prior, as recent China purchases had not yet loaded. Brazil's FOB

Santos soybeans traded near \$437–\$442/MT (\$9.95–\$10.05/bu), maintaining a \$0.30–\$0.40/bu discount to U.S. Gulf offers. ANEC trimmed October export forecasts to 7.00 MMT (from 7.34 MMT), citing delayed lineups and Mato Grosso dryness. Argentine FOBs held near \$455/MT (\$10.40/bu), supported by firm local crush margins and constrained new-crop sales. Chinese crushers booked 2–4 U.S. cargos early in the week but remained mostly focused on Brazilian supply, citing easier VAT processing and freight availability.

So What? Soybeans persist in a split-market dynamic: crushers are bidding actively on meal and board margins, while export demand remains patchy and largely Brazil-facing. Gulf strength and firm Jan/Mar spreads point to solid nearby consumption, but board levels stay tied to central Brazil rainfall and Chinese reengagement. Until one of those variables shifts decisively, futures likely stay rangebound between \$10.70 and \$11.00, with basis and spreads doing the heavy lifting beneath the board.

Wheat Market Deep Dive

Futures & Spreads: Chicago SRW December futures rose 28¢ to \$5.32/bu on Oct 29 (+6 percent w/w), recovering from contract lows on short covering and modest strength in corn and soybeans. The Dec '25–Mar '26 spread narrowed to 15¢ carry (60 percent of full carry, assuming 7 percent interest + \$0.05/bu/month storage/insurance), slightly firmer w/w but still offering ample commercial incentives. Implied volatility remained low (18 percent), with wheat largely following broader row crop sentiment. KC HRW December rose 9¢ to \$5.69, while Minneapolis HRS December added 6¢ to \$6.15.

Global Supply & Demand: Russian 12.5 percent protein wheat FOB offers strengthened to \$235/MT, a \$5 rise w/w, following Moscow's revised floating export tax that boosted domestic replacement values. Despite the uptick, Russia remained the dominant origin into GASC and Turkish tenders. French wheat (Rouen) was offered near \$232/MT but struggled to gain share amid strong Black Sea flows. Argentina's crop outlook held steady around 21 MMT, with SMN citing improved soil moisture. East Australia received light rain midweek, stabilizing late wheat development after prior heat stress. U.S. HRW planting advanced steadily under mostly dry conditions in the central Plains; early emergence remained uneven, particularly in western KS and OK, but no widespread yield concerns were flagged.

Cash & Basis: U.S. FOB SRW Gulf offers remained around \$227/MT (\$6.80/bu equivalent), still \$20–25/MT above Russian competition into MENA and Southeast Asia. HRW FOB held near \$240/MT. Export basis at the Gulf eased another 2–3¢ as shipping programs stayed light and river costs remained elevated. Domestic milling basis was flat to slightly weaker across the Southern Plains, with Oklahoma and Texas bids slipping 2–4¢ on the week. Central state mills (KS, MO, NE) reported slow grind rates and full nearby coverage, with little need for spot bushels. Interior basis levels continued to reflect carry incentives and storage economics, not active demand.

Trade Flows: USDA FGIS inspections totaled 259k MT for the week ending Oct 23, down 46 percent from the prior week's 493k and the weakest total since early September. U.S. exports continued to lag amid poor FOB competitiveness. Russia booked additional volume into North Africa and Middle East tenders, reinforcing its anchor role in global trade. U.S. exporters remained sidelined by both price and logistics, with no flash sales reported and no USDA Export Sales updates due to the government shutdown.

Speculative Positioning: CFTC positioning data was not published for a fifth straight week. CME open interest in SRW futures fell 5.2k contracts w/w, consistent with early-week short covering. Trade desks continued to estimate managed money holding a large net short in SRW, though recent price strength

may have forced some position trimming. Without official COT data, speculative sentiment remained opaque, though futures action reflected technical relief rather than fresh bullish conviction.

So What? U.S. wheat continues as a supporting actor on the world stage, constrained by robust Black Sea volumes and narrow competitive edges. Recent gains were driven more by short-covering than fresh demand, as FOB levels remain \$20–25/MT above rival origins. Spreads confirm ample storage incentives, and basis softness suggests little urgency from buyers. Unless Russian logistics slow, Southern Hemisphere weather worsens, or funds shift posture, U.S. wheat stays rangebound. The complex continues to track row crops and global macro signals, rather than setting its own direction.

U.S. Cash Market & Basis

Corn: River basis remained soft as low Mississippi River levels continued to limit barge drafts and inflate freight. Illinois River bids fell to $-32¢/Z$ ($-2¢$ w/w), while Lower Miss held near $-65¢$ to $-78¢$ under, with spot freight still quoted near \$20.00/ton for Cairo–Memphis lanes. CIF Gulf basis strengthened to $+55$ – $57¢/Z$ ($+3$ – $5¢$ w/w), driven by steady Mexican and Colombian demand and tighter late-month barge supply. Interior processor bids in Iowa and Nebraska stayed firm near even money to $+15¢$, supported by stable ethanol margins and active feed usage. National average corn basis was estimated at $-42¢/Z$ ($-2¢$ w/w), slightly weaker on the week, consistent with strong carry structure and easing flat price.

Soybeans: CIF Gulf bids rose to $+80$ – $82¢/F$ ($+5$ – $7¢$ w/w), lifted by confirmed Chinese purchases and tighter barge spot capacity. River basis was flat to lower, with Illinois River bids near $-32¢/F$ ($-2¢$ w/w), and Lower Miss basis still wide at $-72¢$ to $-78¢$ under. Midwestern elevator bids remained near $-75¢$ to $-80¢/F$, pressured by harvest flow and slow export loadings. Eastern processors (IN, OH) remained aggressive at $+65$ – $75¢/F$, anchored by strong board-crush margins and firm soymeal values. National average basis was pegged at $-72¢/F$, slightly firmer vs. the prior week, though still weak by seasonal standards due to congestion, not supply pressure.

Wheat: U.S. FOB offers continued to lag global values. HRW 11.5% protein held near \$240/MT and SRW near \$227/MT, both uncompetitive against Black Sea offers. Gulf basis eased another 2–3¢ on light export interest and quiet barge activity. Domestic milling bids across OK, KS, and TX slipped 2–4¢ w/w, reflecting adequate pipeline coverage and slow grind demand. Central Plains elevators continued to post nominal interior basis levels, tied more to carry spreads than spot pull. Interior demand remained flat, with no major basis movement tied to new milling or rail activity.

So What? Basis patterns continued to diverge: processors held steady as margins remained positive, while river markets remained under pressure from barge constraints and global trade dynamics. Export-facing basis showed isolated strength in soybeans, but logistics kept most grain bottled up inland. While Mississippi stages remain subdued and FOB spreads remain wide, commercial players remain incentivized to carry grain rather than move it.

International Cash & Trade Flows

Brazil: Brazil sustained its leading role in corn and soybean pricing, despite ANEC's slight downward adjustments to October export estimates. Soybean exports were pegged at 7.00 MMT (down from 7.34 MMT), and corn exports at 6.19 MMT (down from 6.57 MMT), reflecting late-month shipment rollbacks and slow loadings in northern ports. FOB Santos soybeans averaged \$437–\$442/MT (\$9.95–\$10.05/bu), keeping a \$0.30–\$0.40/bu discount to U.S. Gulf. Corn FOB offers held steady near \$203–\$205/MT (\$5.15–\$5.20/bu), sustaining a \$25/MT advantage into Asia. Interior logistics remained functional despite

dryness in Mato Grosso, where planting was delayed. Paranaguá and Santos lineups moved steadily, with exporters continuing to dominate China and Southeast Asia flows.

Argentina: Up-River corn and soy FOBs held steady at \$205/MT and \$455/MT respectively, as farmer selling slowed ahead of the Nov 24 runoff election. The temporary zero-export-tax window expired Oct 31 without extension, prompting an end-of-month sales push but limited forward coverage. Rosario crushers reported steady throughput and adequate raw supply. River logistics remained uncongested. Argentina's wheat harvest preparations progressed in the north, with private estimates still near 21 MMT for 2025/26. Parallel peso rates stayed above 1,000/USD, maintaining FX-driven marketing incentives despite uncertainty around the incoming administration's grain policy stance.

China: China booked 2–4 U.S. soybean cargoes early in the week ahead of the Trump–Xi meeting, but remained focused on Brazilian offers for Nov–Dec. Dalian Jan soybeans held near ¥4,115/MT (\$11.10/bu), while soymeal futures traded at ¥3,100/MT (\$418/ST), reflecting steady crush margins. Jan corn traded around ¥2,540/MT (\$6.40/bu), still well above import parity, but no new U.S. corn purchases were reported. Biotech protocols and TRQ quotas continued to restrict interest. No reserve auctions or government stock moves were announced.

EU / Black Sea: Russian FOB 12.5 percent wheat rose to \$235/MT (up \$5 w/w) as Moscow increased its floating export tax, but volumes continued at full pace into GASC and Turkish tenders. EU wheat offers from Rouen held near \$232/MT, struggling to stay competitive. French exporters cleared prior sales to Algeria and Morocco, but no major new buying emerged. Russian soymeal and corn increasingly displaced U.S. cargoes into MENA markets, aided by lower Black Sea freight and favorable ruble terms. U.S. exporters remained sidelined in key European and North African slots.

Other Origins: No major shifts were reported from Canada or Ukraine. Ukrainian corn reappeared in a handful of Balkan and Turkish trades, but volumes were modest. Canadian spring wheat moved into Mexico and Southeast Asia in container and bulk parcels, but at a slower pace than earlier in Q3. No material offers emerged from South Africa or India this week.

So What? Global trade flows remain dominated by Russia and Brazil, with Argentina's election calendar adding short-term volume but no pricing shift. China remains hesitant on U.S. origin outside token soybean purchases, while high barge freight continues to block Gulf competitiveness. Until FOB spreads compress or river costs ease, U.S. corn, soy, and wheat will struggle to reclaim share. Basis and spreads continue to reward storage over movement.

Key Fundamentals & Reports (Oct 16 – Oct 22)

Government Shutdown: The U.S. government shutdown extended into its 29th day as of Oct 29, continuing to suspend USDA, CFTC, and related federal data releases. No budget agreement emerged during the week, and agency operations remained frozen. Markets once again went without official updates on export sales, crop progress, or fund positioning. Fee-funded FGIS inspections and independent agency figures (EIA, ANEC) remained the only reliable datapoints. Any restart in USDA reporting will likely come with backlogged multi-week data and publication lags into mid-November.

Crop Progress (estimated as of Oct 27): U.S. corn harvest is estimated at approximately 72 percent complete and soybean harvest near 84 percent, both ahead of five-year averages (55 and 67 percent, respectively). Favorable weather allowed uninterrupted fieldwork across the Corn Belt, especially in IL, IA, and MN. Most of the Midwest experienced dry conditions, with some areas nearing completion. No new

USDA conditions or progress ratings were published, but trade consensus pointed to steady crop quality and no frost damage following earlier October cold snaps.

Export Inspections (USDA FGIS – week ending Oct 23, published Oct 28): Corn inspections totaled 1.19 MMT (down from 1.32 MMT prior), with Mexico, Colombia, and Japan leading destinations. Soybean loadings dropped to 1.06 MMT (–33 percent w/w), reflecting timing gaps in Gulf shipments despite active Chinese purchases. Wheat inspections fell to just 259k MT, the lowest since early September, as Black Sea FOBs remained dominant. Western Hemisphere demand continued to support corn and soybean flows, while wheat lagged under FOB pricing constraints.

Export Sales (USDA FAS, not published): No export sales data were released during the week. The last available update remains for the week ending Sep 18 (published Sep 25), leaving traders to rely on vessel lineups and private booking chatter. Market participants cited at least 2–4 soybean cargoes sold to China during the week ending Oct 25, but these have not been officially confirmed due to the reporting blackout.

Ethanol Production & Stocks (EIA – week ending Oct 25 / published Oct 29): Ethanol production declined slightly to 1.091 mbpd (–0.8 percent w/w), but remained 1.2 percent above the same week last year. Ethanol stocks were reported at 23.3 mb, flat w/w. Margins stayed positive as front-month gasoline and corn prices moved in tandem. Weekly grind implied 104 mbu of corn use, keeping processors active and basis supported in the interior.

NOPA Crush: No new crush data were released during the window. The next scheduled NOPA report, covering October volumes, is expected Nov 15. The September crush record of 197.9 mbu (reported Oct 15) remained the reference point for trade expectations. Eastern soymeal basis stayed firm, reflecting continued end-user pull.

CFTC Commitments of Traders: No new COT report was published, marking a full month without official fund position updates. Trade estimates continued to peg managed money net short 50k contracts in corn and 95k in wheat, with soybeans near flat or slightly net long. CME open interest shifts offered little evidence of fresh directional conviction.

So What? For the fifth week running, trading proceeded without government data oversight. Independent assessments indicate harvest progress surpassing norms, alongside minimal concerns over quality or output. Export inspections confirmed steady corn flow and lighter soybean loadings, while wheat remained structurally weak. Ethanol grind stayed supportive, and domestic crush demand continued to anchor interior bids. Until USDA resumes reporting and Brazil's weather pattern resolves, trade direction will continue to rely on physical flows, barge logistics, and processor-led basis signals.

International Reports:

Brazil – ANEC & Weather Updates: ANEC revised October soybean exports down to 7.00 MMT (from 7.34) and corn to 6.19 MMT (from 6.57), citing lineup delays in northern ports and lighter late-month vessel nominations (published Oct 28). FOB Santos values averaged \$437–\$442/MT for soybeans and \$203–\$205/MT for corn, maintaining a clear competitive edge into Asia versus U.S. Gulf. Mato Grosso planting remained delayed by central dryness, with IMEA reporting progress at 60 percent (vs. 56 percent last year). Weather models showed modest relief starting Oct 29, though accumulated rainfall remained well below normal for the month. The BR-163 corridor operated without disruption, and Paranaguá lineups indicated

continued Chinese buying interest for November arrival. CONAB did not publish any new bulletins during the window.

Argentina – Export Tax Expiration and Grain Selling: With the zero-export-tax window closing Oct 31, farmer selling accelerated during the week, especially for old-crop corn and soybeans. Up-River FOB offers held at \$455/MT for soybeans and \$205/MT for corn, supported by steady nearby demand and weaker peso incentives. Private exporters estimated 2.3 MMT of soybeans and 1.4 MMT of corn booked for October shipment, consistent with the surge seen in late September. The Ministry of Agriculture and Rosario Grain Exchange did not publish updated figures. Wheat harvest remained 2–3 weeks away in key northern zones, with production expectations holding near 21 MMT. Parallel peso rates held firm above 1,000/USD, sustaining FX-driven marketing urgency.

China – Soybean Buying Signals, Still Cautious on Corn: Trade chatter indicates Chinese state crushers picked up 2–3 U.S. soybean cargoes during the week, with stems reportedly targeted for late November and December arrival as talks loomed. No flash sales surfaced amid the ongoing USDA shutdown. Dalian January soybeans hovered near ¥4,115/MT (\$11.10/bu), soymeal around ¥3,100/MT (\$418/ST), and corn at ¥2,540/MT (\$6.40/bu), remaining above import parity. TRQ and biotech hurdles continued to cap U.S. corn inflows, while crushers stayed selective on forward U.S. bean bookings despite competitive CFR values. No new customs, CNGOIC, or MARA releases emerged during the window.

Black Sea / EU – Russia Maintains Control: Russian FOB 12.5 percent wheat climbed to \$235/MT on Oct 29 following tax hikes, but export volumes remained high. Russia secured additional sales into Egypt (GASC) and Turkey via private channels. Ukrainian FOB wheat held near \$238/MT, with corn offers closer to \$218/MT, though logistics remained slower than Russian ports. EU wheat (Rouen) hovered at \$232/MT, with limited new sales despite recent French wins into Algeria. Black Sea exporters remained firmly in control of wheat trade dynamics. No material soybean or corn flows were reported from the region into Asia.

Global – Multilateral Updates: No new reports were published by AMIS, IGC, or FAO during the Oct 24–30 window. The last IGC update (Oct 10) showed world corn and wheat stocks stable and soybean production near 401 MMT. Multilateral sentiment remained neutral with no new shocks or major revisions.

So What? Global export momentum remains concentrated in Brazil and Russia. Argentina's pre-election surge in volume added short-term selling pressure, while China's light reentry into U.S. soybeans offered optics without yet shifting trade flows materially. The market remains well supplied, with no major weather or geopolitical dislocation to trigger a shift in price structure. Brazil's rainfall through early November will determine whether soybean yield risk starts to gain traction; until then, U.S. grains and oilseeds remain secondary by price.

Weather & Crop Conditions

United States

Crop Progress & Rainfall: Harvest pace remained active across the Midwest as scattered rainfall early in the week gave way to clear, dry conditions by Oct 20. With no USDA Crop Progress reports due to the shutdown, unofficial estimates place corn harvest at 60–65 percent complete and soybeans at 70–75 percent, both well ahead of average. Eastern Corn Belt fields (IN/OH) experienced minor delays from light showers, while western zones (IA/NE/KS) remained largely dry. First frost was reported midweek in parts of Iowa, Illinois, and Indiana, concluding the growing season without damage and facilitating natural dry-

down. HRW planting advanced under persistent dryness across Kansas and Oklahoma; emergence remained uneven, with topsoil moisture short across most Plains counties.

River Levels: Mississippi River stages remained near seasonal lows, sustaining navigation limits and barge restrictions. Draft guidance remained reduced throughout the central and lower basin, and Cairo–Memphis barge tariffs held above \$19.50/ton, maintaining basis pressure in river-exposed markets.

Temperatures: Seasonal to above-normal readings (2–5°F above average) dominated the Plains and Midwest. Daytime highs in the upper 60s to low 70s allowed uninterrupted harvest windows and encouraged rapid grain dry-down. However, persistent dryness continued to pull down subsoil moisture, especially across the central Corn Belt and lower Mississippi basin.

Outlook (6–10 days): NOAA's latest forecast (issued Oct 20) calls for near-normal temps and drier-than-average conditions through Oct 28 across the Midwest and Plains. Spotty rainfall is expected in the lower Ohio and Tennessee River basins, which may offer minor relief to river levels but is unlikely to restore normal navigation. A weak frontal system could bring light showers to HRW areas in Kansas and Texas Panhandle by Oct 26–27.

South America:

Brazil: Central Brazil (Mato Grosso, Goiás) remained critically dry, with rainfall since Oct 1 at less than 50 percent of normal. Planting progress slowed materially, and IMEA reported Mato Grosso soybeans only 26 percent planted (vs. 43 percent LY). Southern states (Paraná, Rio Grande do Sul) stayed adequately moist, helping stabilize early corn and soy stands. Forecast models showed scattered relief across MT and GO beginning Oct 29, with projected rainfall of 25–45 mm, below normal but better than prior outlooks. Traders remained cautious but had not begun trimming national yield estimates.

Argentina: Central and northern growing areas (Córdoba, Santa Fe, Buenos Aires) saw widespread 25–50 mm rainfall midweek, reinforcing good wheat finish and early corn planting. Soil moisture remained sufficient for row crop establishment, and full-season soybean planting was expected to accelerate into early November. BCBA did not release new condition ratings, but field conditions remained stable.

Global: Russia and Ukraine reported no major disruptions to winter wheat sowing. Soil moisture and fall temperatures remained favorable across key southern and central growing zones. The EU's wheat areas (France, Germany, Poland) also benefited from mild and stable conditions. Australia's wheat belt remained under El Niño stress, particularly in Western Australia, where yield potential continued to erode. No significant precipitation reached key cropping zones during the week.

So What? Conditions for U.S. harvest stay favorable, pushing completion rates significantly beyond typical levels without notable quality setbacks. Basis pressure persists in river-dependent areas due to ongoing navigation limits. The global weather spotlight is firmly on central Brazil, continued planting delays beyond early November could force yield expectations lower. For now, rainfall expected in late October is the pivot. Argentina, Russia, and EU remain seasonally favorable, while Australia trends drier. Net global risk continues to hinge on Brazil's moisture outlook into early November.

Synthesis & Outlook

The period from Oct 24 to 30 persisted in a data blackout from USDA and CFTC, forcing market participants to depend on cash movements, independent estimates, and international FOB indicators. U.S. futures rose modestly across the board: December corn closed at \$4.32 (+4¢), January soybeans rallied to \$10.92 (+27¢), and December Chicago wheat pushed to \$5.32 (+14¢), all aided by early-week short covering and cash market firmness. Spreads held near seasonal averages, corn Dec/Mar at 65

percent, soy Jan/Mar near 50 percent, wheat Dec/Mar at 60 percent of full carry, confirming no imbalance but underscoring steady commercial ownership. River basis remained weak, while CIF and processor bids firmed, maintaining the divide between domestic use and export bottlenecks.

Speculative behavior remained inferred, as no CFTC data was published for a fifth straight week. Open interest was flat in corn and soy, down modestly in wheat, with price strength driven more by positioning adjustment than fresh directional conviction. Volatility remained low, and fund flows showed no signs of reengagement. Cash-led support remained clear: ethanol production dip to 1.091 mbpd and soy crush margins remained positive despite slow inspections. Processor bids held firm across ethanol and crush zones, keeping a floor under basis in the interior.

Globally, ANEC trimmed its October export projections slightly, but Brazil maintained dominance in corn and soy. FOB offers from Santos stayed \$25–30/MT below U.S. Gulf into Asia. Argentina's export pace remained strong into the end of its zero-tax window, with old-crop corn and soy FOBs holding steady near \$205 and \$455/MT respectively. Trade sources are saying that China booked a few U.S. soybean cargoes ahead of the Trump–Xi summit but remained focused on Brazilian origin. Dalian corn is priced above import parity; soymeal at parity, with no TRQ or biotech resolution. Russian FOB wheat rose to \$235/MT after a tax hike but remained the global price floor. No new multilateral reports were published.

Bullish triggers: Shortfalls in anticipated end-of-week precipitation across central Brazil, ongoing Chinese acquisitions of U.S. soybeans, or substantial improvements in waterway conditions to revive CIF values and Gulf edge.

Bearish triggers: Uninterrupted U.S. harvest, continued absence of USDA visibility, and firm Black Sea and South American FOB discounts into core demand centers.

Watchlist (Oct 23 – Oct 29):

Central Brazil rainfall totals and follow-through in Mato Grosso/Goiás planting pace

Post-expiration Argentine grain marketing and FX response after Oct 31

Mississippi River barge draft guidance and freight relief potential

USDA funding resolution and expected timeline for report backfill

Gulf export lineups, ANEC November shipment forecasts, and Russian/Egypt tender flow

In summary: Domestic processor pull continues to support U.S. grain markets in a rangebound setup, though export hurdles keep potential limited. Without a shift in Brazil's weather pattern or fresh USDA catalysts, the complex remains a storage-led, cash-supported market anchored by carry and physical signals, not momentum. U.S. origin continues to play a residual role until global arbitrage narrows or macro sentiment breaks.

Ethanol for America Act

The major barrier to a higher Renewable Fuel Standard (RFS) is the fuel versus food debate. Now is the perfect time to move to E15. Corn prices are extremely low, and the latest USDA WASDE reported a record crop and a record crop expansion.